

A Whole-Animal Approach to Cat Aggression as a Health Signal — Action Checklist

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BASELINE DOCUMENTATION

- ☐ **Baseline Documentation, Item 1:** Complete a baseline inventory across all five domains including activity patterns, food relationships, sleep locations, grooming behavior, and social navigation to create a reference point for detecting what has changed in your cat's behavior.
- ☐ **Baseline Documentation, Item 2:** Document where your cat spends most of her time, her preferred height throughout the house, which rooms she claims, and whether she has abandoned any perches, hiding spots, or favorite resting areas recently.
- ☐ **Baseline Documentation, Item 3:** Record your cat's feeding routine including times, location, whether you free-feed or schedule meals, how enthusiastically she eats, and any recent changes in appetite direction or meal-finishing behavior.
- ☐ **Baseline Documentation, Item 4:** Track your cat's sleep locations separately for day versus night, note whether she sleeps alone or with other cats or with you, and document any sudden changes in her preferred sleeping spots.

MEDICAL INVESTIGATION

- ☐ **Medical Investigation, Item 1:** Rule out pain as the primary cause of sudden aggression before attempting any behavioral training or environmental changes because pain is the most common medical driver of behavioral change in cats.
 - ☐ **Medical Investigation, Item 2:** Prepare for your vet appointment using a medical timeline format that documents when aggression started, what specific triggers produce it, and which body areas your cat now guards or protects during handling.
 - ☐ **Medical Investigation, Item 3:** Know the twelve most common pain-related causes of sudden aggression in cats including dental disease, hyperthyroidism, arthritis, and urinary issues, and specifically ask your vet which diagnostic tests can detect each one.
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- ☐ **Medical Investigation, Item 4:** Track whether your own health changes or hormone shifts correlate with timing changes in your cat's aggression because human hormone changes can cause cats to become clingy, protective, or aggressive as a direct behavioral response.

SAFETY AND REINTRODUCTION

- ☐ **Safety and Reintroduction, Item 1:** Classify your cat's aggression type correctly using the guide's classification system before intervening because applying the wrong intervention to the wrong aggression type will break the reintroduction process.
- ☐ **Safety and Reintroduction, Item 2:** Build a complete behavioral baseline document that you can share with your veterinarian to transform your appointment from a guess into a diagnostic conversation that leads somewhere.
- ☐ **Safety and Reintroduction, Item 3:** Implement a science-based reintroduction protocol that respects your cat's fear and rebuilds household peace systematically rather than forcing proximity before your cat has regained a sense of safety.
- ☐ **Safety and Reintroduction, Item 4:** Establish immediate safety measures including resource separation, controlled interactions, and clear escape routes for all household cats while the investigation into medical causes proceeds.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.